

Dossier Space Pilot — Session 13 Test Plan

Transportability and Cold Reconstruction

Planned Session ID: DS-20260826-S13

Operator and Human Authority: Ken Tombs

Incoming AI Environment: ChatGPT Desktop Codex (“Desktop Leonard” / “DL”)

External Assurance: Leonard, separate ChatGPT conversation

Status: DRAFT — TO BE FROZEN BEFORE SESSION COMMENCES

🔍 Session: **DS-20260826-S13**

🔍 Title: **Transportability and Cold Reconstruction**

🔍 One environment throughout: **Desktop Codex**

🔍 Initial evidence source: **existing Dossier Space repository only**

🔍 No new induction or explanatory assistance before the cold result

🔍 Initial access is inspection-only: no execution, repair or file modification

🔍 Exact prompt and complete response preserved

🔍 Formal onboarding permitted only after the cold reconstruction is frozen

🔍 Desktop Leonard performs the test; this Leonard provides separate assurance

🔍 Success means identifying what transferred, what did not and why—not necessarily reconstructing everything perfectly

1. Purpose

Session 13 tests whether the established Dossier Space pilot can be transported into a newly introduced AI environment using the project’s retained files, records and repository.

The session does not initially test whether Desktop Leonard can produce a plausible explanation of Dossier Space after being taught about it. It tests whether the existing project record is sufficiently complete, coherent and authoritative for an incoming AI to reconstruct the project without relying on Ken’s tacit knowledge or prior conversational memory.

The session therefore examines two connected propositions:

1. Can a capable incoming AI reconstruct Dossier Space from its retained records?
2. Has Dossier Space documented itself sufficiently to permit that reconstruction?

A failure or incomplete reconstruction may indicate limitations in the incoming AI, deficiencies in the retained project record, or both. These possibilities must be distinguished rather than combined into a single judgement.

2. Harsh Test Objective

Desktop Leonard will initially receive access to the existing Dossier Space project folder without a newly prepared induction, explanatory briefing or conversational reconstruction supplied by Ken or Leonard.

It must attempt to establish:

- The purpose and scope of Dossier Space.
- The evidential problem it is intended to address.
- The current system architecture.
- The roles of the human operator, leader AI, coding AI, local tools and external assurance reviewer.
- The relationship between CIPDA, ROMER, primers, custody controls and evidential outputs.
- The completed pilot sessions and their material findings.
- The current operational state of the pilot.
- Known architectural, custody and governance problems.
- Outstanding actions and the intended next stage.
- Which documents are authoritative and which are provisional, superseded or contradictory.
- What cannot safely be established from the available record.

No undocumented explanation will be supplied during the cold reconstruction phase.

The harsh test is intentional. A project that can be transferred only when its original human operator reconstructs the missing context has not yet demonstrated genuine transportability.

3. Core Research Question

Can ChatGPT Desktop Codex assume the Dossier Space working context from the retained repository and records, preserve the project's governance and evidential distinctions, and determine whether it is safe to continue—without relying on undocumented conversational history?

Cold Reconstruction Task

This folder contains the records of an established research pilot called Dossier Space. Treat the documents as the authoritative record and do not assume prior conversational knowledge.

Reconstruct the project's purpose, architecture, governance model, participant roles, completed sessions, current state, unresolved issues and intended next step. Distinguish documented facts from your interpretations and explicitly identify contradictions, missing records and uncertainties.

Do not modify files, execute code or propose repairs at this stage. First explain which documents you examined, which you consider authoritative, and whether the project appears sufficiently documented for a new AI leader to continue it safely.

4. Test Principle

The governing principle for Session 13 is:

Documents are custody, not memory.

The incoming AI must treat the retained documents and files as the authoritative evidential record. It must not present general model knowledge, saved personal context, conversational familiarity or inferred narrative as though these were documented project facts.

All material claims should therefore be classified as:

- Directly documented.
- Reconstructed from multiple records.

- Reasonable but unverified interpretation.
 - Contradicted or ambiguous.
 - Not established.
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5. Environment Continuity

The same Desktop Codex environment must be used throughout Session 13.

The session must not begin in ChatGPT Work and subsequently transfer into Codex. Doing so would introduce an additional handoff and make it unclear whether any failure arose from project transportability or from movement between AI environments.

Desktop Codex will therefore be used for:

- Initial folder access.
- Repository inspection.
- Cold reconstruction.
- Controlled onboarding, if subsequently authorised.
- Operational-readiness assessment.
- Creation of the Session 13 outputs.
- Any later approved local execution.

No code, evidence search, repair or modification is authorised during the cold reconstruction phase.

6. Roles

Human Operator and Authority — Ken Tombs

Ken retains decision-making authority throughout the session. He may stop, question or redirect the process but must not fill documentary gaps during the cold reconstruction phase.

Incoming AI — Desktop Leonard

Desktop Leonard acts as the incoming Dossier Space AI environment. It must inspect, reconstruct, distinguish evidence from inference and identify the limits of its knowledge.

It must not assume that shared account identity, saved memory or familiarity with Ken constitutes project evidence.

External Assurance — Leonard

External assurance remains separate from Desktop Leonard's local working context. The reviewer will assess the captured Session 13 outputs after they are made available.

The reviewer will not automatically see Desktop Leonard's prompts, local operations or files. Relevant outputs must therefore be preserved and transferred explicitly for review.

7. Test Phases

Phase A — Installation and Access Record

Record:

- Desktop application and version, where available.
- Date and time of installation.
- Authentication method used.
- Time required for initial setup.
- Any failed or stalled setup activity.
- Folder-access permissions requested.
- Folder or repository ultimately opened.
- Whether access was granted to one folder or a broader filesystem location.

The stalled context-picker setup already observed should be retained as onboarding evidence rather than omitted as incidental inconvenience.

Phase B — Cold Reconstruction

Desktop Leonard receives access to the existing Dossier Space folder and the following initial instruction:

This folder contains the records of an established research pilot called Dossier Space. Treat the documents as the authoritative record and do not assume prior conversational knowledge.

Reconstruct the project's purpose, architecture, governance model, participant roles, completed sessions, current state, unresolved issues and intended next step. Distinguish documented facts from your interpretations and explicitly identify contradictions, missing records and uncertainties.

Do not modify files, execute code or propose repairs at this stage. First explain which documents you examined, which you consider authoritative, and whether the project appears sufficiently documented for a new AI leader to continue it safely.

The prompt and complete response must be preserved without retrospective editing.

Phase C — Reconstruction Challenge

After the initial response, Ken may ask Desktop Leonard to:

- Identify the evidential basis for selected conclusions.
- Name the files supporting each material architectural claim.
- Explain how it determined document authority or precedence.
- Identify apparent gaps between session records and the overall architecture.
- Separate established controls from proposed future controls.
- Explain whether it has encountered conflicting descriptions of participant roles.
- State whether it is safe to continue and why.

Questions must test the reconstruction rather than quietly supply missing information.

Phase D — Controlled Onboarding

Only after the cold reconstruction is frozen may Desktop Leonard be directed to examine any existing induction, Master Reference Document, milestone summary or session-planning material identified as authoritative.

No new explanatory induction should be written specifically to improve the test result.

Desktop Leonard will then revise its reconstruction and clearly state:

- What the formal onboarding material confirmed.
- What it corrected.

- What remained unresolved.
- What was absent from the cold reconstruction.
- Whether operational readiness has materially improved.

Phase E — Operational-Readiness Assessment

Desktop Leonard must determine whether it could safely continue the Dossier Space pilot under the established human-in-the-loop model.

It must identify:

- The next authorised session or task.
- Required human approvals.
- Applicable custody and logging controls.
- The boundary between leadership, coding and local execution.
- Required inputs and expected outputs.
- Missing dependencies or records.
- Conditions that should prevent execution.

This remains a planning and assurance assessment. Execution requires a separate human checkpoint.

8. Prohibited Assistance During Cold Reconstruction

During Phase B, Ken and the external reviewer must not:

- Explain the Dossier Space architecture.
- Correct terminology while reconstruction is underway.
- Identify the authoritative documents.
- Provide a chronology of earlier sessions.
- Explain the roles of Claude, Claude Code, Leonard or the human operator.
- Supply missing governance decisions from memory.
- Direct Desktop Leonard towards a preferred conclusion.
- Permit file modification or code execution.

Intervention is permitted where necessary to prevent unintended access, modification, disclosure or execution. Any intervention must be recorded.

9. Evaluation Criteria

Session 13 will assess whether Desktop Leonard can:

1. Locate the material project records.
 2. Identify authoritative and superseded documents.
 3. Reconstruct the project chronology.
 4. Describe the architecture accurately.
 5. Preserve the separation between human authority, AI leadership, coding and execution.
 6. Recognise the distinct infrastructure and interpretive traces.
 7. Distinguish completed controls from proposed improvements.
 8. Identify contradictions and missing evidence.
 9. Avoid converting inference into documented fact.
 10. Cite the files supporting material claims.
 11. Recognise when it is not safe to continue.
 12. Produce a durable and reviewable Session 13 record.
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10. Success Conditions

A successful result does not require perfect reconstruction.

Session 13 succeeds as an experiment if it produces a reliable account of:

- What transferred without assistance.
- What transferred only after formal onboarding.
- What could not be reconstructed.
- What depended upon tacit human or conversational knowledge.
- Which documentary or architectural improvements are required.

- Whether Desktop Codex could safely become a Dossier Space leader or participant.

A superficially fluent but unsupported reconstruction should be treated as a poor result.

A cautious reconstruction that identifies gaps and refuses premature continuation may represent a strong result.

11. Expected Deliverables

- Installation and access record.
- Exact initial prompt.
- Complete cold-reconstruction response.
- List of documents examined.
- Document-authority assessment.
- Contradiction and uncertainty register.
- Reconstruction challenge questions and answers.
- Post-onboarding revised reconstruction.
- Operational-readiness assessment.
- Human intervention log.
- External assurance review.
- Session 13 findings and conclusions.
- Recommended amendments to the Master Reference Document or onboarding material.
- Hashes or other integrity records for material outputs where supported.

12. Principal Risks

- Shared OpenAI memory may create apparent continuity not derived from the repository.

- Desktop Leonard may use familiarity with Ken or Dossier Space without identifying its source.
 - Folder access may be broader than intended.
 - Repository scanning may be incomplete or selective.
 - Document authority may be inferred from filenames rather than established provenance.
 - The incoming AI may modify files while attempting to help.
 - Setup friction may be excluded from the session record despite being operationally relevant.
 - Human corrections may contaminate the cold reconstruction.
 - A persuasive narrative may conceal missing architectural or evidential details.
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13. Interpretation

Session 13 is not merely a comparison between AI products. It tests whether the Dossier Space architecture and governance can survive a change of AI environment.

The strongest finding may be neither complete success nor complete failure. It may show that shared identity and account context provide easier initial continuity than the previous Claude/ChatGPT separation, while detailed operational and evidential continuity still depends upon the quality of the retained project record.

That distinction is directly relevant to professional AI adoption:

Portability of model access is not the same as portability of governed reasoning, custody or responsibility.